



140



172E Skyhawk



421C Golden Eagle



Citation Mustang (model 510)

1879 Clyde V. Cessna is born.
1911 Cessna makes his first successful flight.
1925 Cessna forms the Travel Air Manufacturing Company with Walter Beech and Lloyd Stearman.
1927 The Cessna Aircraft Corporation is incorporated in Wichita, Kansas.
1931 The company files for bankruptcy protection and ceases production.
1936 Cessna sells the company to his nephew, who restarts production.
1940 The USAAC orders 33 T-50 light twins.

1946 The 120 and 140 two-seat light planes are debuted and soon achieve sales success, with 7,664 being built.
1950 As the Korean War begins, the US Army increases its order for L-19 observation aircraft, known as the O-1 "Bird Dog."
1954 Clyde Cessna dies. The company produces its first twin-engine aircraft since World War II, the Model 310.
1956 The 172 goes on sale. It will become the most produced aircraft of all time, with more than 43,000 built to date.

1957 Cessna scores another huge success with the Model 150 two-seat trainer, and 23,949 will be built before it is superseded by the 152.
1960 Reims Aviation of France begin producing several types of Cessna under license.
1963 Its 50,000th aircraft is built.
1969 The FanJet 500 flies, eventually leading to an entire family of business jets.
1975 The 100,000th single-engine Cessna rolls off the production line.

1977 Production of the 152 starts, reaching an ultimate total of 7,582 by the time the line closes in 1985.
1982 The Model 208 Caravan enters flight test.
1986 The company is bought by General Dynamics.
1992 Textron acquire Cessna.
2005 Cessna enters the new Very Light Jet market with the Citation Mustang.
2012 Cessna announces a joint venture with Aviation Corporation Industry of China.

Once World War II ended, the company really began to grow. Its all-metal Model 120 and 140 two-seat monoplanes were an instant success, while the large, radial engine 190 and 195 were also very popular. In 1956 Cessna began production of the 172 series. A four-seat high-wing monoplane with a fixed tricycle

impressive, encompassing single-seat Ag-planes, two-seat trainers, four- and six-seat tourers, light twins, business jets, and even military jet trainers.

Although the company has not produced any iconic warplanes, over the decades it has supplied the US military with many aircraft. Its O-1 "Bird Dog" observation plane served

Following several decades of consistent growth, the 1980s saw a sharp reversal in the company's fortunes. Owing in no small part to the highly litigious climate of the era, the market for new General Aviation aircraft collapsed, and sales of Cessna aircraft slumped from 8,400 in 1979 to 187 only eight years later in 1987. Cessna stopped production of light aircraft altogether in 1986, having become a subsidiary of General Dynamics the previous year.

Fortunately, sales of Citation business jets remained strong, while the advent of the overnight air freight industry created a ready market for a new aircraft that Cessna produced from 1985, the single turboprop-powered 208 Caravan. By 2010, more than 250 Caravans were being used by the overnight giant Federal Express, and the type was also selling well around the world. More than 2,000 of this versatile aircraft have been produced, and it remains in production.

Having become a wholly owned subsidiary of Textron Inc. in 1992, Cessna opened a new manufacturing

"I'm going to fly this thing, then I'm going to set it afire and never have another thing to do with airplanes!"

CLYDE CESSNA, AFTER CRASHING HIS FIRST PLANE 13 TIMES

undercarriage, the Skyhawk would eventually become the most produced airplane in history, with more than 43,000 sold to date. Cessna followed the success of the 172 with another bestseller, the 150 two-seat trainer, which first flew in 1955. Ultimately, more than 70,000 of the 150/152 and 172 models would be built, an astonishing number. The 172 is still in production today. Over the next few decades the company continued to grow. By 1963 around 50,000 Cessnas had been built, and only 12 years later this figure had doubled to 100,000. The product line was equally

in both Korea and the early part of the Vietnam War, before being replaced by the C-337 Skymaster. More than 1,000 T-37s were also produced, and, although initially designed as a trainer, many were used as light strike fighters during Vietnam.



Super Tweet in flight

The A-37 Dragonfly, also known as the Super Tweet, is a light attack aircraft first used during the Vietnam War by the USAF. It remains in service with some forces today.



Light corporate jets

The Cessna Citation CJ2 can carry up to nine passengers and is one of a number of light corporate jets used by business executives.

plant in Independence, Kansas, in 1996. This became the home for the company's single-engine piston line. In 2007 Textron bought the bankrupt Columbia Aircraft, announcing that Cessna would produce Columbia's aircraft as the Cessna 350 and 400. This was a significant departure for the company, because the low-wing single-engine airplanes built of composites were different from the all-metal high-wing machines for which Cessna is known. Further changes took place in 2007 when, despite resistance from US customers, a new production facility was set up in China to build a Light Sport Aircraft, the 162 Skycatcher. The downturn in the economy at around the same time led to a number of redundancies, but Cessna continues to produce an impressive range of piston, turboprop, and jet-powered aircraft in Wichita, Kansas.